

Ministry of AYUSH: Drug Manufacturing & Licensing (Page 1)

1. Regulatory Framework for ASU Drugs

Manufacture and sale of Ayurveda, Siddha, and Unani (ASU) medicines in India are governed by Chapter IV-A of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 1940 and the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules 1945. Commercial manufacturing of any Ayurvedic medicine requires a valid manufacturing license issued by the State Licensing Authority (SLA) under the AYUSH department.

2. Classical vs. Proprietary Ayurvedic Medicines

Ayurvedic products are divided into two legal categories: (1) Classical Ayurvedic Medicines, manufactured strictly according to formulas in recognized books of First Schedule, requiring proof of textual reference; and (2) Ayurvedic Proprietary Medicines, which contain ingredients mentioned in classical texts but formulated in a non-classical combination, dosage form, or extract. Proprietary medicines require pilot clinical trials and safety documentation before licensing.

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3. Schedule T Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP)

All Ayurvedic manufacturing premises must strictly comply with Schedule T of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules. Schedule T mandates hygienic factory premises, air handling units, cross-contamination prevention, water purification, qualified Ayurvedic pharmacists, and fully equipped in-house quality control testing laboratories.

4. Quality Control & Safety Testing Parameters

Before commercial release, every batch of Ayurvedic formulation must be tested for Pharmacopoeial standards: limits on heavy metals (Lead, Cadmium, Mercury, Arsenic), pesticide residues, microbial contamination (E. coli, Salmonella), and aflatoxins as specified in the Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia of India (API).